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Frederik Van Geloven

Digital Product Design + UX Strategy

Selected work — product design, design systems & UX strategy

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Foreword and table of contents

By design, this portfolio prioritizes substance over flash — user experience and product design happen throughout the project cycle, and strategic decisions are embedded in each deliverable.

Many of the strongest UX solutions are hidden in the details, or quietly doing their job behind the curtain. Everything here is the result of close collaboration with my team, the audience, and our clients.

For each project I briefly explain the challenge, what we did to address it, and why it matters. I'd gladly tell you more or answer any questions you might have.

The through-line I'd point you to: systems thinking, visual and interaction craft, and design systems that scale — with a deep commitment to accessible, inclusive design.

01 • User interface and interaction design	3
02 • Design systems	6
03 • Data visualization	10
04 • Information architecture and content strategy	13
05 • Thought leadership	18

SECTION 01

User interface and interaction design

Good interface design is mostly invisible — people find what they need without thinking about it. These projects share a thread: complex problems, wide audiences, and interfaces built with real craft and care.

Les Turner ALS Foundation — Interactive decision aid tools

Veterans Affairs — AboutFace

Les Turner ALS Foundation — Interactive decision aid tools

Client: Les Turner ALS Foundation

Interaction design

User flows

Visual design

Accessibility

The challenge

ALS patients and caregivers face tremendous challenges — a lot of information to process and many hard decisions to make, with each patient at a different stage of their journey. The foundation wanted a way to help patients learn about their options and make informed decisions.

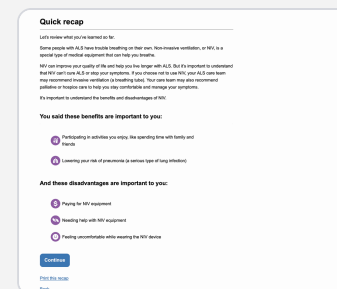
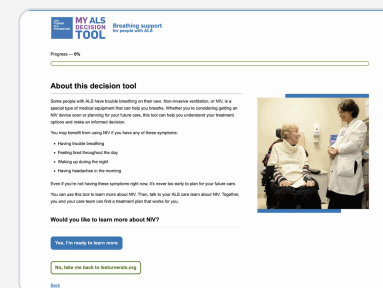
What we did

In close collaboration with people living with ALS, caregivers, researchers, and clinicians, we created a suite of interactive decision-aid tools that communicate complex health information in an accessible, easy-to-understand way. I was responsible for interaction design, user flows, and most of the visual design — including custom iconography for complex ideas — ensuring usability and accessibility at various stages of the ALS journey.

Why it matters

We hear over and over how much of a difference these tools make in the lives of ALS patients and caregivers. They continue to be celebrated by industry professionals and ALS experts. Designing tools that make lives a little better — even when 'better' means 'less hard' — is exactly my professional mission.

2022 ClearMark Award — Best app



Veterans Affairs — AboutFace

Client: Veterans Affairs

UX research

Wireframing

Prototyping

Usability testing

The challenge

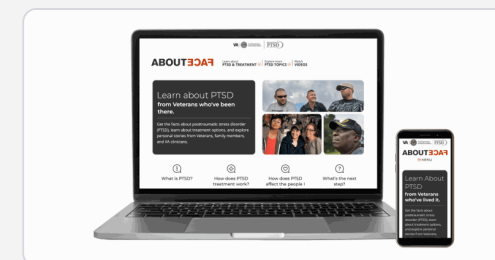
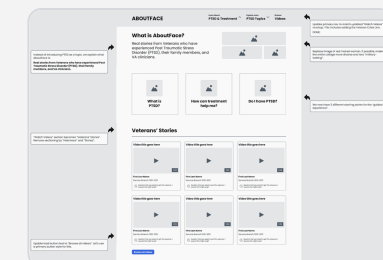
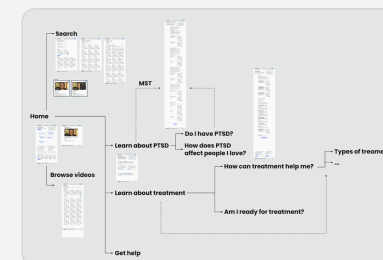
The VA's AboutFace website centers on Veterans' video testimonials about PTSD, alongside family members and clinicians sharing different perspectives. The site needed a redesign that prioritized Veterans' voices, made navigation more intuitive, allowed easier updates, and met federal accessibility standards.

What we did

After concept testing and user research, we reworked the information architecture to simplify navigation and made the video interviews the main focus of the interface. As UX lead, I designed task flows and wireframes, redesigned the IA and navigation, and refocused the experience on the testimonies at the heart of AboutFace — heavily involved in research, from prototypes and moderator's guides to recommendations that addressed the findings.

Why it matters

The challenges Veterans face make it hard to get quality information about PTSD and figure out next steps. This site speaks to them in their own voice. Collaborating with Veterans and clinicians gave the video testimonials the focus they deserve — traffic increased and satisfaction scores improved.



SECTION 02

Design systems

I was building design systems long before they were called that — documenting reusable components mirrored in design and code. When Brad Frost coined 'Atomic Design,' I recognized the pattern immediately. We've come a long way since, and design systems matter more than ever: today the design system doesn't just bridge design and development — it's the core system that makes or breaks agentic, AI-assisted design.

Office of Disease Prevention and Health Promotion

National Eye Institute — Website redesign & design system

Vermont.gov — Statewide Drupal design system

Office of Disease Prevention and Health Promotion

Client: ODPHP

Design systems

UI design

UX research

Information architecture

The challenge

ODPHP's online presence spans several websites that are diverse in purpose and serve a wide range of people. At the same time, it's important there's continuity in the user experience across every property.

What we did

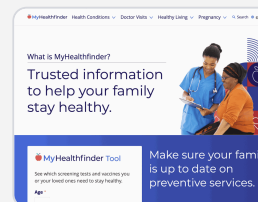
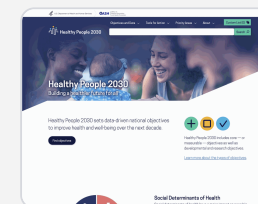
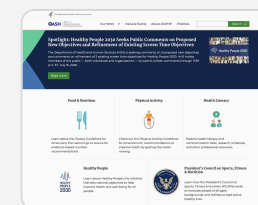
I've served as UX lead on all of the ODPHP properties — involved end to end in research, UX/UI design, prototyping, UX writing, and information architecture. We designed and developed design systems and Drupal CMS environments for each website, with shared, reusable components that keep the whole of ODPHP consistent and coherent.

Why it matters

The shared systems increased adoption, retention, and engagement across all of ODPHP's digital properties while improving usability and accessibility — and letting a small team ship consistently, serving millions of people.

3.5M+

Healthy People 2030 pageviews per quarter — up from ~500K (FY19→FY23)



National Eye Institute — Website redesign & design system

Client: National Eye Institute

Design systems

Component library

Content strategy

Accessibility

The challenge

NEI needed a redesigned, updated website — and a foundation to support a growing family of digital products.

What we did

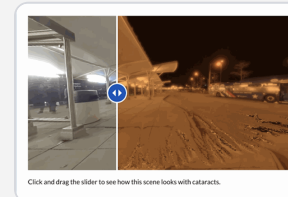
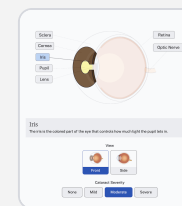
Beyond a more modern look and feel and a complete content overhaul, we built a robust design system from scratch to support the website, marketing assets, and additional digital products — including the Interactive Eye Graphic, the See What I See VR experience, and the Digital Media Library. I led UX strategy, concepts, wireframes, and interactions, partnering with visual designers, engineers, and clinical SMEs.

Why it matters

The NEI website and digital ecosystem became more broadly appealing — to consumers and patients, clinicians, and academics alike. With the system in place, we could add new products to their portfolio quickly and efficiently, all in a user-friendly, accessible, and contemporary interface.

360K+

people reached through the See What I See VR demos at conferences and events



Vermont.gov — Statewide Drupal design system

Client: State of Vermont

Design systems

Drupal

Creative direction

Front-end dev

The challenge

The State of Vermont runs 100+ official websites across dozens of agencies. They needed a consistent, accessible, maintainable web presence that non-technical administrators could run themselves.

What we did

As creative director and UX designer, I designed and developed the Drupal CMS theme and design system used across 100+ State of Vermont websites, led creative direction for Vermont.gov, and mentored front-end developers and state website administrators.

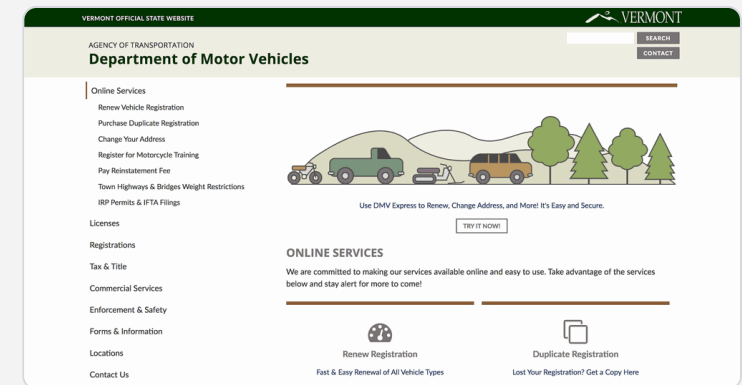
Why it matters

One shared system kept 100+ agency sites consistent, accessible, and easy to update — years before 'design system' was common vocabulary. The program was recognized as Vermont's IT Program of the Year.

2015 StateScoop 50 — State IT Program of the Year

100+

official State of Vermont websites on one shared design system



SECTION 03

Data visualization

Data is only useful if people can interpret it. I love making hundreds of thousands of data points feel approachable — turning complex, technical information into something anyone can read, slice, and act on.

[Healthy People 2030 — Data display](#)

[Healthy People 2030 — Leading Health Indicators infographics](#)

Healthy People 2030 — Data display

Client: ODPHP + NCHS

Data visualization

UI design

Interaction design

Accessibility

The challenge

With over 500 objectives and tens of thousands of associated data points, the UI and interaction design of Healthy People 2030's data display was a big, fun challenge. The data are complex and broad in scope, the audiences diverse, and the visualizations need to be user-friendly across a wide variety of devices and technologies.

What we did

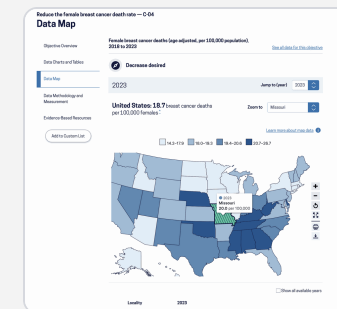
Working closely with ODPHP and NCHS, I created a fully integrated data-visualization tool that lets charts, tables, and maps be customized and filtered based on specific user needs. The visualizations integrate with all 500+ objectives, moving intuitively from a high level down to increasing levels of detail, and we built a user-friendly way to find and interpret disparities data.

Why it matters

Compared to Healthy People 2020, we added functionality while improving discoverability and ease of use. I optimized the interface for both efficiency and simplicity — making the vast amount of data more usable and useful, and greatly increasing adoption and engagement.

16.2M

pageviews in FY2024, up from 14.9M the prior year



Being able to visualize that data, and give people the ability to choose how they want to see it — how they want to slice and dice and manipulate it.

— Usability research participant

Healthy People 2030 — Leading Health Indicators infographics

- Client: ODPHP
- Data visualization
- Plain language
- Content design
- Modular design

The challenge

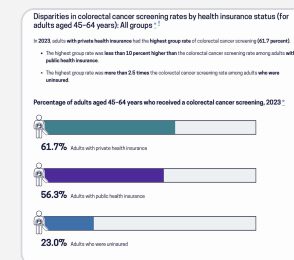
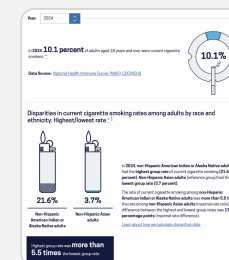
As part of Healthy People 2030, 23 Leading Health Indicators were identified. Being able to easily interpret and visualize the data behind them is key.

What we did

I spearheaded a tool that generates customized infographics for each of the 23 LHIs, pairing bespoke data visualizations with narratives that explain the data dynamically in plain language. The pieces are modular — parts can be pulled out as standalone illustrations across ODPHP's properties, or reused by audiences in their own reports and presentations.

Why it matters

The LHIs signal how progress is being made across all 500+ objectives. Together, the graphics and narratives surface insights and key findings, and the visual representation makes the data engaging to explore.



[This infographic] is really helpful because it clearly puts into words what I could cite, instead of taking extra time to think, how do I say this? It gives me some language.

— Usability research participant

SECTION 04

Information architecture and content strategy

Structure is a design material. Taxonomies, poly-hierarchies, and content models aren't glamorous — but they're what make complex information flexible, findable, and future-proof.

CDC — Contraceptive Decision Making app

U.S. National Water Safety Action Plan

Show Me for Emergencies

CDC — Contraceptive Decision Making app

Client: CDC Foundation

Information architecture

Taxonomy

Content strategy

Interaction design

The challenge

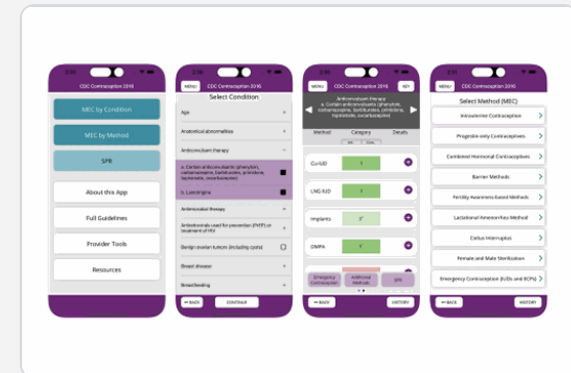
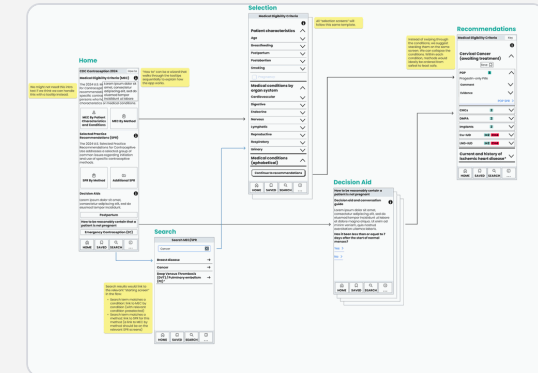
The CDC Contraceptive Decision Making app helps providers explain contraceptive options and limitations, walking providers and patients through decision-making for a variety of methods. The underlying science and the multitude of parameters make the information both complex and technical.

What we did

I conceptualized a multi-faceted, modular system that breaks the content into smaller, interconnected pieces. A combination of logic, taxonomies, and UI/IXD features lets the app support a wide variety of situations, mental models, and preferences.

Why it matters

Contraceptive decisions are highly individualized and personal — the tool had to be flexible enough to account for that without losing detail or nuance in translation. The logic, taxonomies, and content strategy support a conversational flow, so the provider can stay in the moment with the patient while exploring every option and consideration.



U.S. National Water Safety Action Plan

- Client: U.S. National Water Safety Action Plan
- Information architecture
- Taxonomy
- Search + filtering
- WordPress

The challenge

USNWSAP's mission is to prevent drowning in the U.S. through evidence-informed action. A database of 98 Action Recommendations supports this — making it easy to navigate and implement those recommendations is key to the mission's success.

What we did

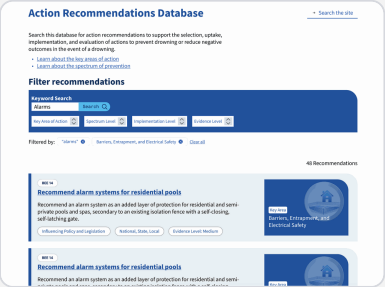
I designed the filter-and-sort system for the recommendations database and wireframed the website. We built a WordPress CMS that integrates the database with the site, so specific recommendations can be pulled into other parts of the site as needed. Because recommendations and taxonomies are easy to edit, the system is future-proof.

Why it matters

Drowning affects people across the U.S. but is preventable. Integrating the database throughout the site made evidence-based recommendations easy to find, interpret, and implement.

4,500+

drowning deaths per year in the U.S. (2020–2022) — the problem we designed against



Show Me for Emergencies

Client: Massachusetts Department of Public Health

Information architecture

Taxonomy

Poly-hierarchy

Iconography

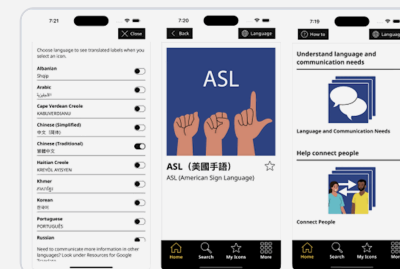
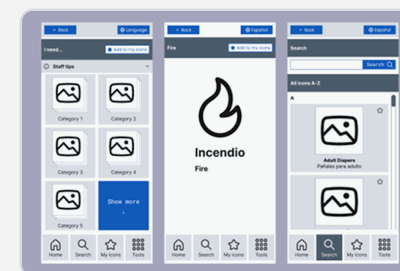
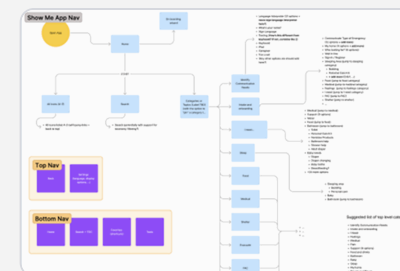
The challenge

The Show Me for Emergencies apps help public-health and emergency workers communicate with people who have difficulty hearing, speaking, or understanding information in emergency settings. Supporting 13 languages and a wide variety of situations, the apps needed a UX/UI refresh for usability, accessibility, and inclusivity.

What we did

I always insist we start with formative research. A usability review and conversations with real-world users led us to consolidate two apps into one. We overhauled the information architecture and navigation, and I proposed multi-homed communication cards in a poly-hierarchy — taxonomies built for maximal flexibility and future-proofing so the same card can surface in many places and mental models.

We added languages and new translation cards and redesigned the iconography for a friendlier look and feel, applying best practices for people with cognitive disabilities or communication challenges throughout.



Show Me for Emergencies (continued)

Why it matters

Usability testing showed the redesign was universally appreciated, and it met a wide range of communication needs. The work expanded the app's reach across languages and situations and improved accessibility and representation — with special attention to cognitive disability — while simplifying navigation and improving usability under stress.

2025 ClearMark Award — Best app

This is really great — I appreciate how you made this work for a variety of people in all kinds of situations. Your idea to implement taxonomies was key to making it flexible and efficient.

— Mass DPH product owner

SECTION 05

Thought leadership

Design gets better when it's shared. Alongside shipping product, I mentor designers, run workshops, and document best practices — because a strong, generous design culture makes everyone's work better.

Talks, trainings, and mentorship

Talks, trainings, and mentorship

Training and mentoring

As a product design strategist and senior UX/UI designer, I mentor and train coworkers across disciplines. One example: a company-wide library of 50+ one-page UX/UI/IxD best-practice write-ups I created and maintain — covering interaction design, accessibility, and usability — adopted by 80+ colleagues.

Talks, presentations, and workshops

I speak and present at UX and public-health conferences (UXPA, Health Literacy in Action, Access for All, among others) on Designing for Accessibility, Digital Health Literacy, Inclusive Design, and Numeracy & Data Visualization. I also lead design-thinking workshops and trainings, online and in person.

Health Literacy Online

I'm responsible for most of the UX/UI guidelines in the refreshed *Health Literacy Online* resource — a research-based guide to creating health websites and digital tools that work for a wide range of audiences. It's the kind of shared, documented craft that raises the quality bar for a whole team.

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Thanks!

I'd love to talk about the work — and how systems-minded, accessible design and design systems that scale can help your team build better products, faster.

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